INDIA LITERACY PROJECT

Multi-Dimensional Learning Spaces

A toolkit for schools and libraries

India Literacy Project

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Arivu Kendra sample edition · Government of Karnataka

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This is a generated sample edition created for the Arivu Kendra public preview. The text on these pages is placeholder prose so that reading tools, previews and downloads can be demonstrated end to end. The real edition will be supplied by the content provider.

CHAPTER 1

What is an MDLS?

How to set up a learning space with a projector, a few laptops and a science kit, and thirty lesson ideas that use them: exploring the Western Ghats in Google Earth, measuring rainfall, mapping the village. Written for teachers and librarians with no technical background.

Before you look for anything in the night sky, give your eyes twenty minutes. In that time the pupils widen and a chemical in the retina rebuilds itself, and stars that were invisible when you stepped outside will simply appear, as if someone had switched them on. Keep your phone in your pocket; one bright screen undoes the whole twenty minutes.

A shadow is only ever as long as the angle of the light allows. At sunrise and sunset the Sun is low and shadows stretch across the whole field. At noon the Sun is high and the shadow shrinks to a small patch at your feet. On two days of the year, at places between the tropics, it shrinks to nothing at all.

Try this: hold your arm straight out and make a fist. The width of your fist against the sky is about ten degrees. Three fists stacked from the horizon is thirty degrees, which on a December evening in Karnataka is roughly where you will find Jupiter. Astronomers have used this trick for thousands of years, and it still works.

Record what you see, even when it seems like nothing. Date, time, where you stood, how clear the sky was, what you noticed. A single observation is a story; a hundred observations from a hundred

villages is data, and data is how we learn things nobody has learned before.

The light from a lamp falls off quickly as you walk away from it. Double the distance and the light on your page is a quarter as bright. This is the inverse square law, and it is why a candle across the room is dim while the Sun, which is a hundred and fifty million kilometres away, can still burn your skin.

A lens does one thing: it bends light. A convex lens bends rays together to a point we call the focus. A concave lens spreads them apart. Everything else, the spectacles, the microscope, the camera, the telescope on the roof of the library, is a careful arrangement of this one idea.

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CHAPTER 3

Thirty lesson ideas

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CHAPTER 4

Using Google Earth

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CHAPTER 5

Maintaining the kit

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CHAPTER 6

Measuring impact

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